

2015

ANNUAL REPORT 2014-15



ASPIRE

90/57, Lower Ground Floor, Malviya Nagar

New Delhi - 110017

3/15/2015

PRE-PRIMARY AND PRIMARY EDUCATION PROGRAM

Learning Improvement Initiative in SDMC Schools of Delhi

ASPIRE, with support from the Tech Mahindra Foundation, intervened in 8 SDMC schools during the academic year 2014-15. The strategy adopted wholesome approach of Learning Enhancement Program (LEP), involvement of SDMC teachers and revitalization of School Management Committees so that the learning needs of children, who transit from primary to the secondary grades / institutions, be taken care of in 5 years.

Learning Enhancement Program - Enabling children to overcome their basic learning deficits, through a comprehensive Learning Enhancement Package, so that they can make use of the classroom inputs, enhance their learning and continue in the school. Tracking each child and keeping their individual record helps us involving each child in the learning process.

Sensitization of school teachers – Orient teachers to change classroom practices and build their capacity in dealing with the first generation learners, so as to stem further accumulation of learning deficits.

School-Community linkages – Restoring the communication between the community and school using the provisions made in the RTE Act regarding School Management Committee, local authority and parents.

Systemic Intervention - Enable each school to become a dynamic, vibrant institution rooted within its own context and community and addressing the specific needs of that context, through School Development Plan.

In 8 SDMC schools our academic intervention is two-pronged – supporting teachers in the classroom at nursery and lower primary grades and remedial for children from grade 3 to 5 and



In 8 SDMC schools our academic intervention is two-pronged – supporting teachers in the classroom at nursery and lower primary grades and remedial for children from grade 3 to 5 and all during the school hours. All in all, 1200 children were covered.

We realize the critical role that the community-school linkage plays in the improvement of schooling experience of children, therefore we ensure continuous engagement School Principals, Teachers, School management committee members and most importantly parents.

Regular dissemination of activities and progress made keeps all key stakeholders informed.

Thousand School Project Odisha

ASPIRE and TSRDS's collaboration for "One Thousand Schools Project: Making Schools RTE Compliant in Selected tribal districts of Odisha" is a five-year project to be implemented in 6 blocks from 3 districts, in Odisha.

The project aims at developing a replicable and scalable model of improving public schools by ensuring implementation of the Right to Education Act, 2009, and to bring about the desired change in the quality of overall schooling experience and ensuring social inclusion, by establishing school-community linkages.

The project will be reaching out to all the key stakeholders in the school education, in the blocks, identified for intervention. This will provide the opportunity to interact with all actors/institutions engaged with the school system; and the model thus evolved, will have factored in the entire gamut of issues and dynamics of engaging with multiple stakeholders like schools, community, PRI structures, CRC, BRC, Block and District level administrative structures and teachers' unions. This would give us the advocacy advantage in influencing the system.

During the first year - 2014-15, the program covered 100 schools in three blocks - Danagadi (Jajpur district) and Harichandanpur and Joda (Keonjhar district).

By the end of the second year, the program coverage will be extended to 1000 schools across 6 blocks in three districts of Odisha.

Geographical Coverage

-Six blocks of three districts of Odisha

-115 Gram Panchayats and around 1000 schools

-It would cover all villages and schools in Danagadi, Sukinda, Harichandanpur and Joda blocks 2015-16.

-Community mobilisation in Koira and Kutra block of Sundergarh district would commence from 2015-16.

School Coverage

-Learning Enrichment Program (LEP) to address learning deficit started in 34 schools of three blocks in 2014-15

-961 boys, 812 girls and 1773 students in total from three blocks were taken after baseline assessment in mathematics and language.

-LEP center in Joda block would start from 2015-16.

District	Jajpur		Keonjhar		
Block	Danagadi	Sukinda	Harichandanpur	Joda	Total
LEP	8	14	12	0	34
Boys	258	355	207	141	961
Girls	206	318	150	138	812
Total Students	464	673	357	279	1773

Children Festival

'Shishu Tarag', a children festival, was organized on three days from 5 to 7 January, 2015 at 10 locations in Danagadi, Sukinda and Harichandanpur blocks, benefiting 4000 students of 43 schools.

Kala Jatha

Kala Jatha, a theatre program, was organized at 40 different villages covering all GPs of Harichandanpur block in February.

District	Jajpur		Keonjhar		Sundergarh		
Block	Danagadi	Sukinda	Harichandanpur	Joda	Koira	Kutra	Total
GP	22	25	25	15	12	16	115
Villages	106	105	200	117	109	54	691
Habitation	300	224	505	396	575	478	2478
Schools	156	151	205	136	159	104	911

INTERVENTION IN SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL IN DELHI

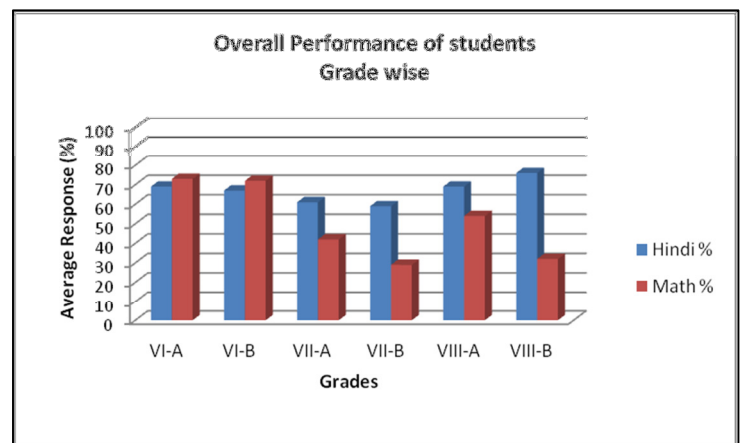
ASPIRE, with support from the Tech Mahindra Foundation (TMF, hereinafter), initiated a program in the Government aided Senior Secondary Girls School – Kasturba Ballika Vidyalaya. The initial intervention covers grades 6 to 8, which subsequently will be extended to grade 12. The entire intervention is based on consultations with the School management, teachers, TMF leadership and observations of ASPIRE team.

In this school, we are supporting the first generation learners in securing foundations of learning to become independent learners, and also to pave the way for them to go on to complete schooling with quality learning achievement. To meet the requirement of each learner, multilevel teaching and assessment methodology has been devised in classrooms, after examining the baseline performances of students. Worksheets for differential capacities of students have been prepared and implemented.

By working with the KBV teachers, a process of systemic integration has begun, as they are expected to become the change agents within the school. In addition to these, close engagement with the school leadership and School Management Committees will help in bringing schools and communities together.

For every child, a file is maintained for systematic tracking of their daily progress and is shared with the teachers and parents during the Parent-Teachers Meeting (PTM).

To invoke thought process in teachers regarding a vision for the school and children. The use of “visioning” method was necessitated to facilitate participants to see a way through the difficult issues and then trace backwards to form strategy.



The use of “visioning” method was necessitated to facilitate participants to see a way through the difficult issues and then trace backwards to form strategy.

This exercise was just a beginning to understand the teachers’ vision for themselves, school and children.

The strategy includes key focus areas - Access, Learning, Participation, Governance and Systemic integration - a continuum that provides a cohesive framework for intervention.

ASPIRE RESOURCE AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT CENTER

ASPIRE Resource and Technical Center continues to evolve and during the year 2014-15, ASPIRE signed Terms-of-Reference with Tech Mahindra Foundation for evaluation of its School-Adoption Program.

Tech Mahindra Foundation supported, ASEEMA Charitable Trust, Akanksha Foundation, Naandi Foundation and Mukhtangan (an initiative of Paragon Charitable Trust) which are working with the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai, to bring about a positive change in the quality of education in English medium Municipal Schools.

This evaluation meant to provide an objective account of the project and its impact and was essentially participatory in nature, involving all major stakeholders in the process of enquiry.

This evaluation had certain limitations - first, it was limited by time, both in terms of availability of beneficiaries and the extent of participation of the key stakeholders, especially organizational heads & key program personnel. Secondly, though all the four organizations were collaborating with MCGM under the common scheme called MPS scheme they followed different approaches and their terms of engagements were different from each others.

The biggest limitation was non-availability of complete documents, reports from the evaluating partners.

Key Findings

Relevance

The growing demand for English medium quality education among the parents is the issue which all organizations attempt to address and also claim to develop a model of high

quality English medium free education for marginalized children which can be replicable and sustainable. Mukhtangan has shown the way to create a model wherein the *“Education for the community by the community”* not only establish positive relations with the parents but also deepens community’s stake in the school.

Effectiveness

Organizational and Program leaderships of respective organizations have been closely monitoring the progress because of its policy significance. Naandi has partnered with MCGM, in more than one program (School excellence Program) and has successfully scaled up both the programs’ since 2009. Other organizations are looking at very limited number of schools.

Impact

One of the clearest achievements of the intervention has been the impact on the learning outcomes of children, where the organizations have created safe and clean learning environment. ASEEMA and Mukhtangan have implemented the entire intervention as a *process*, and not as an event.

Sustainability

NGOs have not been able to access MCGM fund stipulated in the MPS scheme. One due to absence of concrete mechanism and norms for funding private partners within the MCGM and second partners with exception of Nandi Foundation are not keen in pursuing this matter. TMF’s intervention has served an important purpose in terms of benefiting several thousand children. But replicability and scalability of the interventions, in most cases will require repositioning of these interventions.

Recommendations

- ✓ Need for evolving a common framework with sufficient flexibility to address local specific concerns, as currently no common framework/approach exists which all the partners follow. Four Mumbai programs are under the Mumbai Public School (MPS) program and engaging with MCGM under the PPP policy but they also differ in their approaches and do not have a common framework.
- ✓ There is a need for creating common forum/platform for sharing among partners to allow cross-fertilization of ideas and innovations. Each partner has developed some niche area and there is great possibility to learn from each other's experiments. But in absence any platform to share these experiments these are not being integrated in the work of other partners.
- ✓ Need for standardization of reports and data by TMF so that the entire process is captured and there is no data/information loss.
- ✓ Need for getting a common report of programme implementation as well as expenditure, wherever there are multiple funding sources for common programmes/programme framework, a common report as well as expenditure statements by partners.
- ✓ Leveraging TMF funds to optimize uses of existing physical, human and financial resources, instead of substituting government funding.

- ✓ Defining roles and responsibilities of School Management Committee, is an essential task that organizations need to take up.
- ✓ Interventions to be oriented towards addressing systemic issues. In other words supporting programmes and interventions which can be sustained and replicated